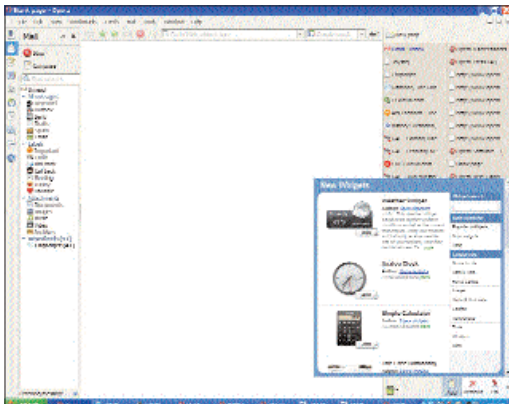


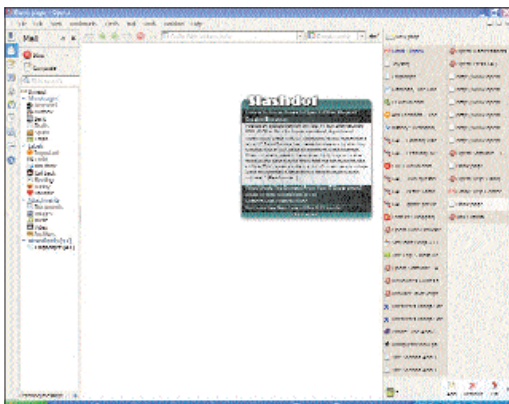
ters based on To, From, Subject, and other fields. To do so, right-click on the Mail panel and click on New Filter; name the filter, click on the Rules tab, and then on New Rule to add rules based on the listed criteria. For the highest efficacy, select the "Learn from messages added..." checkbox.

Finally, Opera can also serve as your IRC chat client. You can surf your favourite DALnet and Undernet channels using Opera. Each chat window is treated as a separate tab, and downloads are handled via the same Transfers window that is used by the rest of the browser. To enable this client, go to **Tools > Mail And Chat Accounts**, then New, and then Chat (IRC).

With a comprehensive e-mail client, an RSS/Atom reader, a contacts manager and an IRC chat client, Opera ably offers a comprehensive package for staying connected to the WWW. Notably, the new version of Opera—version 9.0—is also set to introduce BitTorrent support and introduce widgets to the browser—applets that brings in information snippets from the Net. These could be news, RSS feeds, stock prices, and so on.



The upcoming version of Opera adds desktop widgets to the mix



This widget lets you view the latest Slashdot posts. Note that the widget is visible even if the browser is minimised

Issues 2.0

Opera's Web rendering engine is second to none. It's fast and accurate, and is especially great in a low-memory, dial-up setup. It's not all rosy in the Opera camp though. Although the browser strives to be 100 per cent W3C compliant, Web developers are far from getting there. Every now

and again you will stumble upon a site that doesn't render quite right under Opera. For example, the Gmail/Google Talk integration does not work. You can report a problematic site with a few simple clicks, though: to do so, go to **Help > Report A Site Problem**.

The so-called Web 2.0 era is fast approaching. AJAX Web sites already offer desktop-quality software online, as is evident when using sites such as Writely, Gmail, and Flickr. The Web browser, then, is poised to become an even more important element in our software repertoire. Little wonder then that Microsoft is scrambling to blur the lines between its desktop and online offerings, via both its upcoming Windows Vista as well as online services such as Live.com. The Mozilla Foundation also has great plans for Firefox, as does the Konqueror team which has risen to prominence thanks to Safari's use of the KHTML rendering engine.

The team behind Opera has done wonders with this little package. The browser is winning market share in the mobile market—it can be found on Symbian and Windows-powered cell phones, PDAs, and the Nokia Internet Tablet, and will soon be available on the Nintendo DS handheld gaming console. There is competition in the air, and that's a *Good Thing*. ■

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